



ForumIAS

(Don't Write anything in this Area)

c) What is social stratification? Discuss the grounds/types of stratification world-wide. (15 Marks)

Social stratification refers to division of society into different stratas or hierarchical social order.

→ When in a society, there is unequal access to economic resources, power, prestige, status etc, social stratification occurs in such societies.

Different grounds of stratification are

① Caste based stratification -

→ It is a feature of Indian society.

→ The society is divided into caste based hierarchy.

→ Some castes have higher position in the hierarchy and enjoy more privileges and prestige as compared to others.

→ M.N. Srinivas said that Dominant Caste in a region attains higher

position in the hierarchy.

→ The lower caste groups have to face discrimination, deprivation and inhuman practice of untouchability.

→ The interdependence among castes is also shown through Jajmani system as elaborated by William Lister.

→ The process of assimilation also takes place in such societies where lower caste groups imitate the dominant caste.
(M.N. Srinivas)

② [Clan Based Stratification]

→ It is a feature among the Western societies.

→ Clan based stratification has monetary aspect.

→ Those who are wealthiest are at the top of hierarchy and poor constitute

the lower class.

→ Inter-clan marriages are also prohibited in such societies.

③ Clergy Based Stratification

→ It was a part of France when there was feudal system before French revolution.

→ The society is divided into 3 groups.

- Clergy - 1st estate
- Nobility - 2nd estate
- Commoners → 3rd estate.

→ It is still a part of some groups in Brazil & Latin America.

+ Functionalists like Malinowski & Durkheim opined that social stratification promotes group solidarity & economic cooperation.

But Marxists, said it is a cause of all conflict & revolution in a society.

Feedback

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Structure/
Question
Content
Value
Total